

Job Description		
Title Deputyship Officer	Department: Adult Social Care and Health	Post Ref
Job Purpose At Nottinghamshire County Council, people are at the heart of what we do. Our Adult Social Care department is centred around making a difference in social justice and promoting equality of outcomes and access for everyone in Nottinghamshire. Adult Care Financial Services (ACFS) are a crucial part of achieving this vision by aiding people with lived experience, including carers and providers, on all aspects of finance and income maximisation. This role will contribute to this through the following: • supporting our journey to becoming a strengths-based organisation • fulfilment of the Corporate Director's delegated role of Deputy or Appointee for people who lack capacity to manage their own finances		
Key Responsibilities 1. Undertake the Corporate Director's delegated role of Deputy or Appointee as required and directed in connection with management of finances for people who lack capacity to manage their own finances and/or are physically disabled. 2. Negotiate on behalf of service users in connection with asset disposal and ensure that the best possible prices are obtained. 3. Seek and be aware of individual service user needs and wishes, apply for funds to their benefit, and ensure that all monies are accounted for and receipted where appropriate. 4. Complete and submit service user annual accounts and reviews to the Office of the Public Guardian. 5. Monitor expenditure in relation to the Deputy bank account supporting people with their financial queries and helping people with mental health needs, a history of self-neglect and other complex needs and disabilities budget and spend appropriately.		Key Accountabilities 1. 100% of people have all their assets and entitlements to enable them to access appropriate services and maintain a safe standard of living in accordance with their wishes and financial means. 2. 100% of people for whom the Council is a Deputy avoid debt that puts them at risk and are protected from financial exploitation. 3. 100% of care contributions are paid in a timely manner for your caseload. 4. 100% of performance targets and service standards are consistently achieved across volume, quality, experience, and impact for your caseload. 5. Appropriate arrangements are in place for debt accumulated prior to the Council having legal authority for people's finances for all new cases within 6 months of referral / or 4 weeks of contact from creditors when

6. Develop and maintain positive relationships with people using a Strength Based Approach to facilitate them to maintain their independence and make choices that support their wellbeing. 7. Assess individual people's needs and develop and co-ordinate appropriate support that ensures people can maintain their independence and remain in the community delaying the need for long term care and support. 8. To apply for the granting of Deputyship Orders or Direction of the Court of Protection as appropriate and to ensure compliance with formal Directions and Instructions. 9. To collect all types of service user income, pay accommodation fees, maintenance costs and outstanding bills, and to operate and reconcile the bank accounts relating to financial transactions made on behalf of service users and account for all transactions. 10. To adhere to safeguarding policies and procedures using your professional judgement to make appropriate referrals in a timely manner. 11. Seek and act on both formal and informal feedback from people and carers with lived experience ensuring that your own practice continually improves and highlighting any issues to the Team Manager that have implications beyond your individual practice. 12. Complete mandatory training requirements and priorities for continuing professional development. 13. Negotiate with providers and creditors to reconcile any charges and ensure continuity of care and other essential services until	the Council is or becomes the Corporate Deputy. 6. Where there is a next of kin, 100% of deceased accounts are effectively settled within 3 - 6 months 7. All unclaimed estates cases which are over 12 months are followed up as a minimum every 6 months. 8. Where there no next of kin, 100% of deceased accounts are referred to the genealogist service within 1 month. 9. Compliance with relevant legislative requirements, statutory guidance, regulatory standards, and practice guidance is maintained at all times when operating systems and processes; recording provides a clear audit trail of and the rationale for decisions which is consistently evidence based.
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financial resolution can be completed. 14. Facilitate continuity of care and services for self-funders who have accumulated debts putting in place bridging arrangements and monitoring and extending these as required until all legal authority is gained by the Council to act as Corporate Deputy. 15. Engage, communicate, and clarify information for all invested parties following the death of a person for whom the Council is the Corporate Deputy ensuring consistency in the arbitration and conclusion of all financial matters. 16. Mediate between estranged family members following the death of a person for whom the Council is the Corporate Deputy ensuring independence and neutrality is maintained whilst taking into account differing views and wishes and supporting people to find solutions to the problems and issues arising following their relative's death. 17. Operate systems and processes in line with organisational requirements and the data protection act, adhering to the controls in place to minimise the risk of fraudulent activity. 18. Maintain manual and computerised information recording systems and procedures and provision of statistics, returns and other information.	
Key Behaviours to support cultural priorities	
1. Model a pro-active approach to meeting the commitments of the Nottinghamshire Plan and working towards a healthy, prosperous, and greener future. 2. Nurture a caring and empowering culture that empowers people and encourages them to act with resilience and support themselves, people with lived experience, including carers and each other every day by making ASCPH a great place to work where	

everyone is willing to listen and collaborate.

3. Model working collaboratively, creatively and in partnership to create solutions that make Nottinghamshire better for ourselves, our teammates and our communities.

4. Ensure all communications are grounded in respect and compassion, focus on people's strengths rather than their needs and deficits and use authentic and empathetic language.

5. Set a positive professional example by practising ownership, self-sufficiency and unconditional positive regard for others so that people have a greater sense of belonging and feel cared for and valued by their peers and leaders.

The post holder will perform any duty or task that is appropriate for the role described

Person Specification

Education and Knowledge

1. Educated to degree level or equivalent.
2. Knowledge relating to the Data Protection Act.
3. Knowledge, understanding and commitment to the principles of equality and diversity.
4. Knowledge of general health and safety issues in the workplace.

Experience

1. Experience of working for a minimum of two years in a financial setting.
2. Experience of providing information and advice to the public
3. Experience of using Excel, Access and Word
4. Experience of listening, consulting and communicating effectively

Personal skills and general competencies

1. A high level of personal drive and commitment to excellent customer care and the ability to set an example for other staff
2. Strong interpersonal skills to gain the agreement and acceptance of others including colleagues, senior managers and customers.
3. Ability to make decisions and solve problems to meet operational targets, involving devising solutions and prioritising the resources available.
4. Ability to meet agreed objectives and delivery of targets by the effective use of resources.
5. Ability to make sound decisions, in the interests of people for whom the Council is the Deputy or Appointee, having

at all levels, both verbally and in writing 5. Experience of providing excellent services. 6. Experience of interpreting complex information and communicating this to a wide range of people and professionals.	considered all information available. 6. Ability to organise, prioritise and monitor your own work to meet tight deadlines 7. The flexibility and commitment required to work in a team. 8. The initiative to work alone.
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Role Dimensions

1. To be responsible to the Team Manager of the Appointee and Deputyship Service.
2. To administer finances for people for whom the Council is an appointed Deputy in line with internal and external procedures, relevant regulations and any parameters set out by the Court of Protection.
3. Workload management, time management and case management of own caseload.
4. Implementing the agreed quality assurance framework.
5. Identification of and negotiation of support to deliver the requirements of Deputyships.
6. Oversight of finances, benefits, debt management and financial investments for deputy cases, total value approx. £3-£5 million.
7. Supporting the Council's journey to become a strengths-based organisation.
8. To administer, safeguard and invest service user finances in line with internal and external procedures and relevant regulations.

Date 19th March 2023